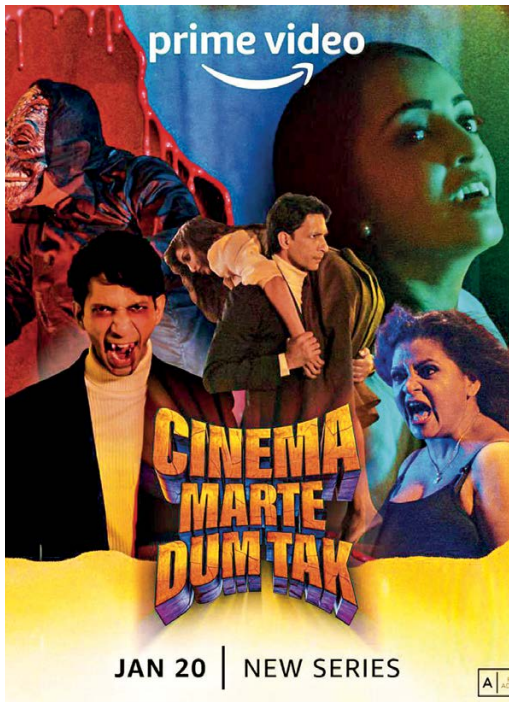
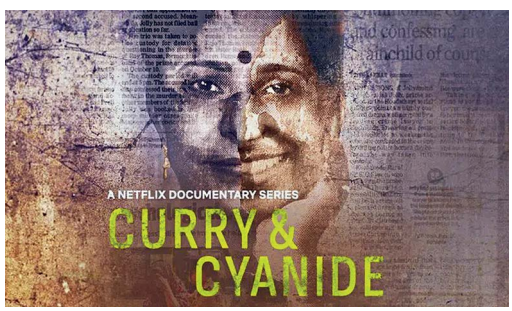
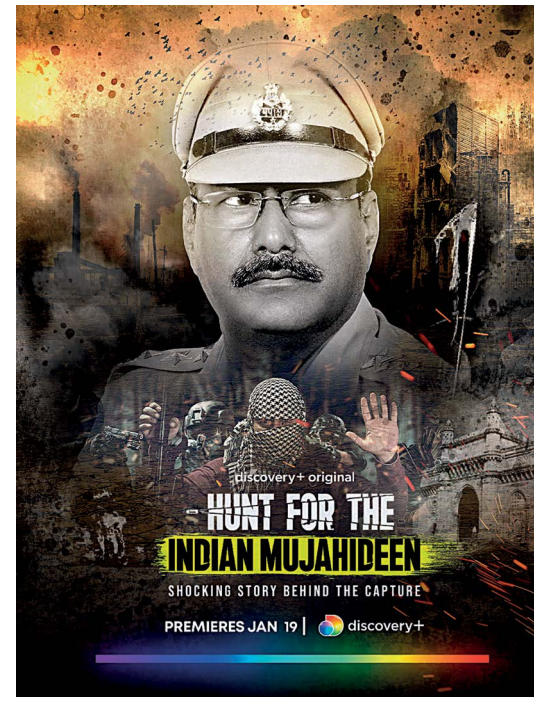






NON-FICTION FARE
Netflix's upcoming series *The Indrani Mukerjea Story-Buried Truth* (far left); Prime Video's *Cinema Marte Dum Tak* (left); Discovery+'s *Hunt for the Indian Mujahideen* (right); Tanuja Chandra-directed *wedding.con* streaming on Prime Video (below left); and Netflix's feature *Curry & Cyanide*





"IT'S HEARTWARMING THAT A CATEGORY DYING FOR AN INDUSTRYWIDE UPLIFT IS FINALLY SEEING IT"

–SAI ABHISHEK *Head, Factual & Lifestyle Cluster, South Asia, Discovery*

The boom for unscripted content can be attributed to viewers' exposure to international shows and OTT platforms' own need to have a diverse slate

Hunt for the Indian Mujahideen and *History Hunter*. "It's heartwarming to see," says Abhishek, "that a category that's dying for an industrywide uplift is finally seeing it."

The boom for non-fiction, or unscripted content as it's termed in streaming parlance, can be attributed to viewers' exposure to international content as well as the streaming platforms' own need to have a diverse slate, not to mention financial constraints. Budgets for documentary series are nothing in comparison to fiction titles, which are far bigger in scale and where production costs include actors' fee. Streaming platforms "realised a lot of fiction was not giving a bang for the buck, so let's supplement it with cheaper fare," says Abhishek. That investment has paid off and an influx of genres has emerged within unscripted content. If Netflix has given us multiple seasons of *Fabulous Lives of Bollywood Wives*, Prime told viewers the story of popular musician A.P. Dhillon.

At Discovery Plus, besides its staple adventure/survival and lifestyle genres, history and mythology shows are the flavours of the moment. "As Indians, we have [for long] been seeing our history through the white gaze," says Abhishek. "Now is the time for us to start telling these stories. There has been a concerted interest among us, as a society, to know about our past and rethinking it with a fresh lens and new insights." The documentary viewer, he notes, is seeking not